



PensionApp User and Admin Manual

UPS PensionsGo

Operational guide for day-to-day users, supervisors, administrators, and support teams.

Audience	Operational staff, supervisors, administrators, and support teams
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1.1	2026-05-28	User and admin manual refreshed for the current application modules, governance flows, and support procedures.	OpenAI Codex	Pending

Approval and Sign-Off

Use this page during review and handover to record document acceptance, ownership, and the latest approval state.

Role	Name / Team	Signature	Date
Prepared by	Operations Documentation		
Reviewed by	Admin Lead / Pensions Office		
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Note: If the contents do not populate immediately, open the document in Word and update fields.

System: UPS PensionsGo Description: Current operational guide for staff, supervisors, administrators, support users, and pensioner-facing operators. Version Manifest: app_version.json -> 1.0.0 / build 20260401.1 / schema 5.2.2 Repository Snapshot Date: 2026-05-28 Preferred Deliverables: docs/PensionApp_User_Admin_Manual.docx, docs/PensionApp_User_Admin_Manual.pdf

Manual Profile

Field	Value
Intended audience	Operational staff, supervisors, administrators, support teams, and trainers
Current application scope	Pension intake, workflow, registry, payroll, arrears, messaging, live chat, content, pensioner services, lifecycle reporting, and administration
Recommended use	Onboarding, day-to-day operations, governance support, and issue triage
Related references	docs/PensionApp_System_Documentation.md, docs/PensionApp_Technical_Documentation.md, docs/ERD.pdf, docs/role_manuals/README.md

1. Introduction

UPS PensionsGo is the working platform for pension administration activities across retirement intake, claims follow-through, pension-file registry management, payroll reconciliation, arrears accountability, messaging, live chat, public support content, lifecycle reporting, and pensioner self-service.

This manual explains how the implemented application should be used in practice. It is written against the current system, not an earlier proposal baseline. It focuses on what users do, how modules are meant to be used, where governance controls apply, and what support teams should check first when something goes wrong.

Where a team needs role-specific step-by-step guidance, use the dedicated role manual suite in docs/role_manuals/ alongside this general operational manual.

2. Who This Manual Is For

User group	What to focus on
Clerks and intake staff	Staff-due capture, application handling, status updates, and record quality checks
OC/Pension and deputy supervisors	Dashboard oversight, task routing, delete governance, system priorities, and exception handling
Workflow officers	Write-up, file creation, data entry, assessment, audit, approval, and task progression
Registry and records staff	Pension file registry, document uploads, file movement, life certificates, and recycle-bin governance
Payroll and finance staff	Payroll cycle uploads, payment-register handling,

	suspensions, gratuity schedules, claims payments, and budget support
Administrators	Users, roles, permissions, public settings, active sessions, imports, exports, backups, restores, notifications, cleanup, and system health diagnostics
Support staff	Login issues, access issues, live-chat/message issues, data-state checks, and role-aware troubleshooting
Pensioner-support operators	Pensioner dashboard behavior, lookup consent rules, restricted profile-edit cases, account resets, and death-report follow-up

3. Access, Roles, and General Rules

3.1 Role Awareness

Every protected area of the system is role-aware. A user only sees the pages and actions allowed by the current role and any extra permission overrides.

Core roles used by the system include:

Role	Typical responsibility
Administrator	Global governance, settings, users, roles, imports/exports, backups/restores, notifications, cleanup, diagnostics
Clerk	Staff-due intake and verification support
OC/Pension	Operational control, routing, and data-management oversight
Deputy OC/Pension variants	OC/Pension-equivalent access where governance permits delegated control
Write-up Officer	Write-up preparation
File Creator	File creation and registry establishment
Data Entrant	Structured data capture and updates
Assessor	Benefit assessment and calculations
Auditor	Audit-stage review
Approver	Final approval-stage control
Pensioner	Limited self-service access

3.2 Access Rules All Users Should Know

- Protected pages require a valid login session.
- Pensioner login can be enabled or disabled centrally by settings.
- Maintenance mode allows administrator access while blocking ordinary users.
- Sensitive administrative actions may trigger re-authentication.
- Data Management is restricted to administrators and OC/Pension-equivalent leadership roles.
- Seeing a menu item is not the final authority. The server also checks role and permission rules before acting.

3.3 Security Expectations

- Keep passwords private and never share accounts.
- Use approved devices and trusted browsers where possible.
- Respect timeout warnings and re-authentication prompts.

- Treat exports, uploads, documents, message attachments, and printed data as sensitive records.
- Use the governed workflow instead of informal shortcuts, especially for deletion, restoration, and payment-related actions.

4. Getting Started

4.1 Login

Users sign in through the Login page. The platform supports email or phone-based login, depending on the data stored for the account.

During sign-in, the system may apply:

- invalid credential checks
- lockout windows after repeated failures
- pensioner portal enable/disable rules
- maintenance mode restrictions
- password-expiry checks

If login fails:

1. Confirm the correct identifier and password.
2. Confirm whether the account is a pensioner account and whether pensioner login is enabled.
3. Confirm whether the system is in maintenance mode.
4. Escalate to an administrator or support lead if the account still cannot be used.

4.2 Session Behavior

The platform monitors inactivity and session state. Depending on settings and role, it may:

- limit concurrent sessions
- warn before inactivity timeout
- terminate older sessions after conflicts
- require password confirmation for sensitive admin actions

Users should save work promptly and avoid leaving sensitive pages open and unattended.

4.3 Navigation Pattern

Most secure pages follow the same pattern:

5. Open the page from the main navigation or dashboard shortcut.
6. Apply search and filter controls first.
7. Review cards, tables, or analytics.
8. Open a modal or detail panel for the selected record.
9. Submit changes through the provided form or workflow action.
10. Wait for confirmation before leaving the page.

5. Core Operational Modules

5.1 Dashboard

The Dashboard workspace is the shared operational cockpit. It provides quick insight into:

- claims exposure and period totals
- pensioner composition and demographics
- life-certificate compliance
- payroll coverage
- staff due pipeline
- file registry and file movement status
- workflow performance
- feedback management
- general statistics and controlled data management

Good practice:

- use dashboard figures as decision support, then confirm in the source module
- check filters before exporting or reporting numbers
- refresh a section before escalating unexpected totals

5.2 Staff Due for Retirement

Staff Due for Retirement is the entry point for retirement-bound staff records.

Typical tasks:

- add a new staff-due record
- review retirement and contact information
- update submission or application status
- attach supporting documents where the workflow permits
- request deletion through the governed staff-due delete flow

Important reminders:

- confirm identifiers such as regNo, supplier number, phone number, and retirement details before saving
- use workflow status tools instead of informal notes to move work forward
- do not bypass the delete-request process

5.3 Applications and Claims

Applications and claims are no longer a simple record list. The current claims workspace includes:

- arrears ledger review
- recent-payment logging
- bulk payment upload
- suspension upload history
- monthly gratuity schedule analysis
- strategic estate-expiry and full-pension-due views for privileged users

- export builders for custom arrears summaries

Users should:

- confirm claim type before recording a payment
- distinguish expected amount, paid amount, and remaining balance correctly
- submit accountability files promptly when required
- use bulk upload flows for structured batches instead of repeated manual entry

5.4 Pension File Registry

The pension file registry is the authoritative post-intake record.

Typical actions:

- search and open registry records
- update permitted record details
- review document index and linked metadata
- request registry deletion
- process approved deletion requests where authorized
- restore deleted items from the recycle bin where allowed

Good practice:

- confirm the correct file before editing
- use the governed edit forms rather than direct database-side changes
- keep linked documents properly classified and attached to the correct record

5.5 File Movement and Life Certificates

The records area includes two operationally sensitive flows:

File movement

- record every file movement when custody changes
- include destination, reason, and expected return date where applicable
- close the movement when the file is returned

Life certificates

- confirm the correct year before marking status
- treat Submitted, Not Submitted, and Exempt as distinct states
- verify file number, name, station, or phone before changing a record

5.6 Payroll, Suspensions, and Budgeting

Payroll and finance staff now work across several linked flows:

- upload a monthly payroll source file
- attach or replace a signed payment-register PDF
- replace a payroll cycle where authorized
- review matched and unmatched rows
- upload suspended payroll amounts

- upload gratuity schedules and review allocations
- review or export budget views

Operational rules:

- confirm month, year, quarter, and financial year before upload
- do not casually replace a payroll cycle
- review unmatched rows immediately after upload
- preserve source files and generated reports according to retention rules

5.7 My Tasks and Workflow Alerts

The My Tasks workspace is the day-to-day execution layer for routed work.

Users can:

- review assigned tasks
- add comments
- change task status
- inspect alerts
- process completion-queue items where permitted

Supervisory users can:

- assign and delegate work
- adjust due dates and priority
- review stalled or overdue work
- resolve alert pressure

Good practice:

- use workflow actions, not only comments, to move state
- keep comments factual and brief
- review alerts before they age into escalations

5.8 Messages and Broadcasts

The messages module supports:

- direct messages
- broadcast messages
- live chat and group chat
- presence/call support where enabled
- attachments
- unread tracking
- attachment viewing
- configurable notification sounds

Users should:

- keep message subjects clear and traceable

- use broadcasts only where role and purpose justify it
- attach only necessary files

Messages are part of the operational record and should be treated accordingly.

5.9 Feedback, FAQ, Terms, and Podcast

The support/content surface now includes:

- governed feedback intake and workflow handling
- FAQ management
- terms/policy clauses
- staff/public podcast video management

Feedback managers should:

- classify the issue correctly
- assign ownership when clear
- move the item through review, resolution, and closure with a useful summary

6. Pensioner Support Guidance

The pensioner portal currently exposes:

- profile summary
- application-progress view
- benefits snapshot
- payroll and compliance view
- claims and arrears summary
- lifecycle and indexed-document view
- controlled contact update flow
- lookup visibility and consent controls
- account administration and password resets by authorized staff
- pensioner death-report follow-up

Support staff should know:

- pensioner login may be disabled centrally
- pensioner lookup is consent-driven
- some fields are intentionally restricted in special lifecycle states
- restricted fields should be updated through the correct staff-side route, not forced through self-service

When supporting a pensioner:

11. Confirm the linked registry record.
12. Confirm current account status and portal visibility.
13. Check whether the requested field is under a restricted rule.
14. Use the registry or admin route if self-service should not apply.

7. Administrative Functions

7.1 Settings

The Settings menu opens the primary governance workspace.

Common functions:

- system status and diagnostics
- user and pensioner account management
- app settings and public settings
- role and permission governance
- active-session review
- backup and restore
- imports, exports, storage, and cleanup
- FAQ, terms, and podcast administration
- notification sound library and queue controls
- app-version and public-visibility settings

7.2 System Health Diagnostics

The Settings workspace includes a system health view driven by:

- tb_system_logs
- tb_system_log_resolutions
- notification queue status
- memory and disk pressure checks
- unresolved warning/error incident grouping

Administrators should use it to:

- inspect open incidents
- review notification delivery problems
- mark incidents acknowledged, resolved, or dismissed after real handling
- monitor whether the same subsystem keeps failing

7.3 Users, Roles, and Permissions

Good practice for account administration:

- assign the least-privileged role that still enables the user to work
- prefer role-level permissions over one-off user overrides
- review pensioner accounts separately from staff accounts
- use pensioner death reports as governed lifecycle notifications, not as informal registry edits
- use administrator accounts for governance, not routine case work

7.4 Data Management and Restore

The Data Management area includes controlled maintenance tools.

Key rules:

- registry deletion uses a request queue plus recycle-bin recovery model
- staff-due deletion uses a separate approval queue
- restore should only be used after confirming the record is legitimate and safe to reintroduce
- purge should follow policy, not convenience

7.5 Settings, Imports, Exports, and Backups

Administrators can control:

- branding and footer/public information
- session and password policy
- workflow timing
- notification behavior
- document and attachment rules
- storage cleanup thresholds
- pensioner portal visibility
- analytics and digest behavior
- geolocation/session behavior
- app version and public-service behavior

Operational guidance:

- back up before large imports, cleanup, or destructive actions
- review filter scope before export
- document important settings changes affecting access, retention, or security

8. Troubleshooting Guide

Symptom	First checks	Escalation path
User cannot log in	Credentials, lockout state, maintenance mode, pensioner-login setting, account role	Administrator or support lead
Menu is visible but action fails	Session, effective role, permission override, server-side policy	Administrator or OC/Pension lead
Dashboard numbers look wrong	Filters, refresh state, latest upload cycle, source module totals	Module owner or supervisor
Payroll totals do not match	Active cycle, month/year, unmatched rows, register upload, replacement history	Payroll lead
Registry item seems missing after deletion	Delete request state, recycle bin, restore eligibility	Authorized data-management user
Attachment or document issue	Allowed type, size, storage setting, viewer availability	Administrator or support
Pensioner cannot update contact details	Restricted lifecycle rule, consent setting, linked registry data	Registry support or administrator
Notification, live-chat, or digest issue	Queue state, email transport, sound setting, attachment storage, system health diagnostics	Administrator

9. Operating Discipline and Handover

Users should apply the following habits consistently:

- update the correct record, not a similar-looking one
- use governed forms and workflow actions instead of workarounds
- process delete and restore work only through the correct queue
- keep uploads relevant, properly named, and policy-compliant
- confirm figures in the source module before external reporting

Support and leadership teams should:

- record major access changes
- document why sensitive settings were changed
- log import, restore, cleanup, and purge actions through normal governance flows
- hand over unresolved issues with enough context for the next operator

Appendix A. Quick Page Reference

Function	Menu / workspace
Main operational dashboard	Dashboard
Admin console	Settings
Staff due intake and review	Staff Due for Retirement
Claims and arrears workspace	Claims
Pension file registry	Pension File Registry
Payroll upload history	Payroll Upload History
Messages	Messages
Live chat	Messages / shared chat widget
Tasks	My Tasks
Pensioner dashboard	Pensioner Dashboard
Users management	Users
Feedback page	Feedback Centre

Appendix B. High-Value Admin APIs

Purpose	Representative APIs
Settings	get_app_settings.php, update_app_settings.php
Users and roles	get_users.php, register_user.php, get_roles.php, update_user_permissions_admin.php
Active sessions	get_active_sessions.php, terminate_other_sessions.php
Diagnostics	get_system_status.php, manage_system_health_diagnostics.php
Notifications and live chat	get_notification_queue.php, get_notification_sound_library.php, live_chat_poll.php, live_chat_send.php
Backup and restore	create_system_backup.php, restore_system_backup.php
Imports and exports	process_data_import.php, run_data_export.php, download_data_artifact.php

Cleanup and storage	run_data_cleanup.php, get_storage_usage.php
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Appendix C. Related Technical References

- docs/PensionApp_System_Documentation.md
- docs/PensionApp_Technical_Documentation.md
- docs/ERD.pdf
- docs/erd.md
- docs/erd-domains/interdomain_links.md
- docs/versioning.md